Small Plates

for the table

A fine warm up to a game night, or a quick dip when time is scarce

Coup — *Indie Boards and Cards — $17*

2 - 6 Players // 15 minutes // Lightweight // Social Deduction

A fast bluffing game that's perfect for groups. It’s easy to learn with only one action per turn and five total roles in the game. Even though it’s simple and quick, the strategy, social deduction, and role interactions make it exciting and different each time you play.

Deep Sea Adventure — *Oink Games — $20*

2 - 6 Players // 30 minutes // Lightweight // Push-your-luck // Sabotage

In this game, players are diving for treasure. The treasure gets more and more valuable the deeper they dive. If they gather too much treasure or go too far they will run out of oxygen and lose it all! Oxygen is a shared resource, which adds an interesting collaborative (or sabotage!) element to the game. It’s easy to learn but has enough strategy to keep it interesting.

Graft (Limited Edition) — *IV Studio — $30*

3 - 5 Players // 30 - 45 minutes // Lightweight // Card Drafting // Push-your-luck

Farm, fish, and forage to gather the perfect harvest in this game for 3-5 players. Draft cards, collect sets, and fill your cargo with valuable goods to send back to Zenith, but don't wait too long to ship it or risk busting! I made my family play over Thanksgiving, and get this, they asked ME to play it over Christmas.

Moonrollers — *IV Studio — $30*

2 - 5 Players // 30 - 45 minutes // Lightweight // Push-your-luck // Set Collection

A standalone push-your-luck dice game for 2-5 players featuring familiar faces and themes from the Moonrakers universe. Attempt contracts, hire crew, and push-your-luck in an addictive game of strategy and chance. Nothing beats the feeling of rolling a ~~mouthful~~ handful of dice. It's also a great way to trick your friends who were scared of Moonrakers to want to play Moonrakers. That was always the goal.

Petiquette — *Oink Games — $23*

2 - 6 Players // 20 minutes // Lightweight // Pattern Recognition // Social Deduction

You've got opinions. They might be right or wrong, but for this game all that matters is whether other people agree with you. The cards feature (adorable) ducks, dogs, and cats wearing different colored hats. Need I say more? OK fine. Each turn five random cards are placed on the board and a "?" card somewhere in the mix. The players secretly pick a card to replace the "?" card that they think fits the pattern on the board. If someone chooses the same animal and hat as you, you both earn points! A breezy game that reveals fascinating things about what people consider a pattern. You may never look at your friends in the same way.

Pick n Packers — *Oink Games — $23*

3 - 6 Players // 20 minutes // Lightweight // Finger Dexterity // Rotating Teammates

Work together with another player to carry a drone stacked with presents from one landing zone to the next. Each player only uses one finger so the slightest difference in pressure or speed can cause the presents to fall and cause you to fail your mission. Hilarious to watch and play. Another crowd pleaser from Oink Games that can be enjoyed with players of all ages. (well for legal and frustration reasons maybe stick with 7 + year olds)

Ra & Write — *25th Century — $30*

2 - 5 Players // 20 minutes // Light → Medium Weight // Flip-n-Write

Who doesn't love a good flip-n-write? (Flip and write games are games where cards get flipped and dictate potential actions or rewards that the player utilizes.) Ra & Write combines luck, skill, and maybe yelling. Your strategy is determined by the cards flipped and the actions other players take. It's a really satisfying game that rewards proactive thinking with chaining effects, combinations, and bonuses that feel fulfilling to achieve. (Don't tell anyone, but I liked it better than Ra.)

Scout — *Oink Games — $20*

2 - 5 Players // 20 minutes // Lightweight // Hand Management // Strategy

Truly a modern classic. Scout is a ladder-climbing game where players try to find sets or runs in their hand to beat what is on the board, BUT! Players may NOT rearrange their hand of cards, and players may pass their turn to take a card from the current high set of cards into their hand. The game feels kind of like a mixture between gin and war. It’s tactical but easy enough to be played with distractions. If you have any semblance of a game collection, this is a must-have. Nominated for the 2022 Spiel Des Jahres.

Time To Panic (Limited Edition) — *IV Studio — $30*

1 - 4 Players // 30 - 45 minutes // Lightweight // Cooperative // Puzzle // Strategy

History has been shattered! Your team of multiversal agents must work together to reconstruct the timeline before it’s too late. Time to Panic is a co-operative card game for 1-4 players where you arrange cards in order from numbers 1 to 36. On each turn players add a card to the timeline and perform its action and the action of a neighboring card. Just as order is starting to be achieved panic cards sow chaos. I've taught Time to Panic a multiverse amount of times and always want to play once I'm done.

Tropichaos — *Oink Games — $23*

2 - 5 Players // 20 minutes // Lightweight // Push-your-luck // Inventory Management

In Tropichaos, players gather and try to sell fruit in its peak season. Seasons can change unexpectedly when a season chip is drawn so figuring out the right time to sell is key. This classic push-your-luck game is fun and easy to pick up. (Plus it fits in your pocket! Assuming you have largish pockets.)